

ather data about what works or does not work to encourage people to spend time on our site or convert on a form. With testing, we can make informed decisions about what works for our audience and helps them reach their goals, and what works for us to help use meet our business goals.

Types of experiments

Website tests

A/B Test: tests two variants of a page

A/B/n Test: tests two or more variants of a page

Multivariate Test: tests variants with two or more different sections

Redirect Test: tests separate web pages identified by different URLs or paths

Personalization: personalize your page for targeted visitors

Requesting a Website or Email Test

1. Build a test: If you would like to request an a/b or multivariate test, create an issue for Digital Marketing Programs using this template.

1. Keeping it MVC: Not all changes to changes need to be tested. We should test changes to our key conversion pages, and these pages/elements are key areas we test often:

- Homepage

- Top navigation

- Pricing page

- Free trial

- Contact sales

1. Please check CODEOWNERS to see if a page being tested. We updated the Active tests sections, @shanerice and @dmor will appear as approvers on any MRs with active tests.

Before you experiment

Always gather relevant heatmaps, analytics, metrics, KPI (key performance indicators), etc.

Announcing tests

We will announce major tests in whats-happening-at-gitlab on Slack. A major test is anything on a page with more than 10,000 pageviews in the last 30 days. For example, tests on /pricing/, /free-trial/ and sub-pages, and the homepage would all qualify as major tests. The announcement should share basic details and timeline of the testing and link to the test issue for additional context.

The DRI for the test should share the original Slack announcement in appropriate channels (sales, marketing, etc.).

Testing Tools

We use different tools for different kinds of tests.

Feature flag tests replace entire pages or large sections of a page with a test.

WYSIWYG tests replace small elements of a page or update copy.

Hotjar tests measure interactions on a page for research before and after tests.

Testing via feature flags

This is where we plan to do the bulk of our testing. We can run several of these at the same time. For full-page, partial-page, component, and small changes. Right now we use Launch Darkly for feature flag testing. This tool is administered by @bradonlyon, please ping him with any questions about the tool. You can request a test with the AB Test template.

Launch Darkly measures tests with click data which is a more accurate method of measuring interactions than cookie-based analytics. It's important to remember this data won't reconcile with cookie-based analytics like Google Analytics or Snowplow.

You can review each the control and test variant in review apps or live on about.gitlab.com with either `?experiment-review-control` or `?experiment-review-test` respectively.

Feature flag best practices

Feature flags should be implemented in code similarly to the includes system. Example:

Login to our third party service and create a feature flag and related configuration variables.

Assign ownership of that flag from within the interface.

Edit a page.

Put the existing contents of the page into an include file named `/source/experiments/1234-control.html.haml`, where `experiments` is the folder name instead of `includes` and `1234` is the id number of the associated issue. "Control" refers to the baseline measurement you are testing against.

Duplicate that include file with the name `/source/experiments/1234-test.html.haml`

Make your changes and validate the feature toggle works locally and/or on a review app before deployment.

Ensure you'll be able to collect all the data you need. Setup appropriate tools like heatmaps and analytics.

Note that one advantage of feature flags is that they can be released to production without being turned on.

When ready, enable the test. Start gathering data.

If needed, run experiment with only control to collect baseline data.

Testing via CDN

This is an advanced tool meant to test large-scale changes at a systemic level. For now we plan to run only one of these at a time.

Testing via WYSIWYG

We use Google Optimize for these tests. There are performance impacts with large-scale tests so we only use this platform for testing a handful of CSS elements or copy changes.

To enable Google Optimize on any page you add googleoptimize: true to the frontmatter of any page.

Testing with Hotjar

Use this link to request a heatmap test or results for a page on about.gitlab.com.

New heatmaps will record data until the page has reached 2,000 pageviews. An Search Marketing Manager will ping you when the results are complete (Duration depends on average traffic to the page. Some tests can take up to a month or more.)

Note: Every page viewed by a visitor is counted as a single pageview.

Test launch checklist

When launching a test there are many GitLab team members that the Inbound Marketing team needs to notify. For the best coverage we'll post one message in [whats-happening-at-gitlab](#) and then crosspost to the following channels. Please add any additional channels and ping the Search Marketing team in [search-marketing-team](#) to make sure we notify everyone who wants to track tests.

Channels we share original update:

- 1. marketing
- 1. sales
- 1. ceo
- 1. supportteam-chat
- 1. sgrowth

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/_index.md

Integrated Marketing

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Team Mission Statement

Be the strategic growth engine for GitLab by creating and accelerating high quality demand, partnering ecosystem-wide and being platform champions.

Team Norms

We are a team that transparently communicates wins, challenges, and marketing insights that helps us feel connected to our purpose as a team and a company.

We are tightly connected and operate as one respectful, supportive and collaborative IM team, communicating a united story about our reason to be, the context in which we operate and why we move in an intentional direction.

We are innovative, strategic, and data-driven, delivering a cohesive high quality marketing

motion that aligns across our joint stakeholder goals.

The Integrated Marketing works across SMB, Mid Market and Enterprise segments as well as globally in the Americas, Europe/Middle East and Africa (EMEA) and Asia-Pacific (APAC) to create relevant game plans and thoughtful execution, enabling GitLab to:

- Generate high quality, high-propensity demand
- Partner ecosystem wide, including the channel, alliances and the community
- Be champions of the DevOps platform

We are innovative, strategic, and data-driven, delivering a cohesive high quality marketing motion.

Team Norms (how we operate)

We are a team that transparently communicates wins, challenges, and marketing insights that helps us feel connected to our purpose as a team and a company.

We are tightly connected and operate as one respectful, supportive and collaborative IM team, communicating a united story about our reason to be, the context in which we operate and why we move in an intentional direction.

We are innovative, strategic, and data-driven, delivering a cohesive high quality marketing motion that aligns across our joint stakeholder goals.

Teams (what we do)

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Digital Experience

Digital Experience: Responsible for creating customer-centric approach to educating prospects on how GitLab enables them to deliver software faster and more securely on the marketing site.

Corporate Events

Corporate Events: Create experiences through 1st and 3rd party events to bring awareness to the GitLab story and build our presence with key audiences.

Digital Strategy

Digital Strategy: Leverage paid and owned media tactics to foster awareness, generate leads and reach audiences where they engage.

Account Based Marketing (ABM)

Account Based Marketing

Campaigns

Campaigns: Deliver creative ways of telling the GitLab narrative, through different channels, formats and platforms.

Lifecycle Marketing

Lifecycle Marketing: Engage, nurture and convert customers across the customer journey.

Regional Marketing

Field Marketing

Field Marketing: Be the feet on the street, creating local and regional experiences, learning and evangelism in close partnership with Sales.

Channel Marketing

Channel: Exponentially grow GitLab's reach through the ecosystem to build awareness and generate demand.

OKRs/Goal/Plan (how we impact)

Integrated Marketing OKRs cascade from CMO OKRs

FY25 IM strategy

How to Communicate with integrated Marketing

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

You can find us on Slack in the [marketingintegratedmarketing](#) channel.

Cadence of meetings within Integrated Marketing

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We value our asynch value and believe that people truly need time to think and process. The Integrated Marketing team, like all GitLab team members, should feel empowered to decline meetings based on the agenda topics.

The IM team meets the 1st and 3rd Wednesday of the month and the time rotates between being EMEA/AMER & AMER/APAC timezones. We discuss key cross-functional issues, our progress on our OKRs for the quarter, and to ideate how we can better unify our marketing motions, as well as having a little fun getting to know each other!

Monthly Regional Readouts with Sales

Each month, Integrated Marketing meets with regional Sales Leadership to discuss key metrics and team updates.

This GitLab Epic (confidential) documents the past readouts as well as preparation for the future readouts monthly.

See this doc for details on consistently pulling metrics for Monthly Regional Readouts (GitLab Internal)

Cross-functional team processes

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Publisher Programs

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Due to the fact that teams outside of the digital marketing team are only allowed to run three paid social campaigns a month, we would not want to use one of our three slots for the month to run a publisher program with a publication that we already have relationship with. This is for two reasons: 1. To work with our 3rd party ad agency, there is 12-15% fee that is based off the ad spend of the publisher engagement to accommodate their services and reporting 2. because we do not want to take the place of a paid social campaign. Should we go down the route of wanting to work with a publisher, then the team member should collaborate by tagging the Campaign Manager & Digital team manager who you normally work with in the campaign issue. By tagging this team in your issue, the Campaign Manager & Digital team member will be able to ensure the publisher engagement does not conflict with existing activities running.

Regional Sales leaders seeking approval for activity outside of Mktg Supported countries

For strategic reasons, a regional leader may desire marketing activity outside of the agreed upon marketing countries of focus. As such, this issue template should be used to seek approval.

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/corporate-events.md

Mission Statement

The mission of the Corporate Events Team is to:

- Tell the GitLab story through engaging events

- Make customers the hero

- Build lasting and trusting vendor and internal relationships

- Help elevate the attendee/customer's GitLab experience during events

What does the Corporate Events team handle?

Sponsored events

- Events with a global audience of 5000+ attendees for NA

- 3000+ for other territories (50% or more of audience is national or global).

A handful of smaller events that we handle due to the nature of the audience, product specific, and the awareness and thought leadership positions we are trying to build out as a company.

- The primary goal is always driving brand awareness but that cannot be the only result.

Owned events

- GitLab DevSecOps World Tour, our User & Customer Conference

Internal events

GitLab Summit, our internal company and core community event

Please review our events decision tree to ensure Corporate Marketing is the appropriate owner for an event. If it is not clear who should own an event based on the decision tree, please email events@gitlab.com.

Meet the Corporate Events Team and How to Reach Us

Kate Demarest - Senior Director, Corporate Events - @kdemarest

Kelley Stowe - Senior Manager, Corporate Events - @kagarrett

Kelly Walker - Senior Partner Program Manager, Exec Engagement @kmwalker

Marina Conrad - Senior Corporate Events Manager - @marinaconrad

Amanda Shen - Corporate Events Manager - @amandawshen

Suli King - Corporate Events Content Manager -@sstuelp

Lauren Roberts - Corporate Events Manager - @lroberts

Current Slack Corporate Event Channels

Slack Channel	Use
corporate-events-team	General planning questions and open to all team members to inquire about upcoming or past events
devsecops-world-tour	General DevSecOps World Tour planning questions and open to all team members to ask any questions

If you'd like to email us instead, please reach us at

General Questions: [events at gitlab dot com](https://gitlab.com/events)

Summit-related Questions: [summit at gitlab dot com](https://gitlab.com/summit)

DevSecOps World Tour-related Questions: [events at gitlab dot com](https://gitlab.com/events)

How We Evaluate and Build Potential Events

All GitLab events must check at least three or more of the goals of our events below to be considered.

1. Brand awareness- we want to be a household name!
2. Build community
3. Evangelize a remote-first culture
4. Gain contributors
5. Share GitLab thought leadership
6. Help with hiring great future teammates
7. Gather new relevant leads/ drive ROI
8. Educate possible buyers or users on our product or features
9. Communicate the marketplace positioning
10. Promote Partnerships and Alliances

Corporate Events must also meet

1. Audience minimum requirement will vary based on the type of sponsored event
2. Audience demographic requirements. We consider the balance of roles represented (contributor, user, customer, potential hires), and the Global reach of the audience. Audience profile must be over 50% national/ global.

If you are looking to request a new Corporate Event, please use the following issue template

Questions we ask ourselves when assessing an event

How and where will this event position us as a brand?

Does this event drive business goals forward in the next quarter? Year?

How does this event drive business goals forward in the new quarter? Year?

Is the event important for the industry, thought leadership, or brand visibility? We give preference to events that influence trends and attract leaders/decision makers. We also prioritize events organized by our strategic partners.

Will there be a GitLab speaker? We do not require a speaker slot in return for sponsorship but we do prioritize events where the audience will be hearing about GitLab - either from a GitLab team-member or a member of the wider GitLab community.

What type of people will be attending the event? We prefer events attended by diverse groups of decision makers with an interest in DevOps, DevSecOps, Cloud Native, Kubernetes, Serverless, Multi-cloud, CI/CD, Open Source, and other related topics.

Will we be able to interact with attendees? We stress events that provide opportunities for meetings, workshops, booth and/or stands to help people find us, as well as create other interactions with attendees.

Where will the event be held? We aim to have a presence at events around the globe with a particular focus on areas with large GitLab communities and large populations of support.

What is the size of the opportunity for the event? We prioritize events based on their potential reach (audience size, the number of interactions we have with attendees) and potential for ROI (also account for cycle time).

What story do we have to tell here and how does the event fit into our overall company strategy, goals, and product direction?

Do we have the bandwidth and resources to make this event a success? Do we have the cycles,

funds, collateral and runway to invest fully and make the event as successful as possible?
Events must be weighed against other current activity in the region and department.

Suggested events will be subject to a valuation calculation - will it meet or exceed objectives listed above?

Corporate Events Strategy / Goals / OKRs

Brand

For Sponsored Events: Get the GitLab brand in front of 15% of the event audience. 40,000 person event we would hope to get 4,000+ leads (10%) and 5% general awareness and visibility with additional branding and activities surrounding participation.

Human touches- Tracked by leads collected, social interactions, number of opportunities created, referrals, current customers met, and quality time spent on each interaction.

Audience Minimum Requirements- volume, relevance (our buyer persona, thought leaders, contributors), reach (thought leaders?), and duration of user/ buyer journey considered.

ROI

Work closely with Integrated Marketing colleagues to ensure events are driving results and touching the right audience.

Exceed minimum threshold of 8X ROI for any events that also have a demand generation.

Aim to keep the cost per lead for a live event around \$100.

Thought Leadership and Education

Corporate Events Team OKRs are aligned quarterly to the Integrated Marketing (therefore the CMO) OKRs.

Creating Content for Owned & Internal Corporate Events

Content Process

Corporate Events Owned & Internal Content DRI's

Overall Content DRI: Senior Management in Product Marketing or otherwise assigned by senior management, will vary based on event

Corporate Events Content Manager DRI: Suli King @sstuelp

Ensures that the content workstream team is on track to create, review, and finalize content for owned & internal events.

Brand Compliance DRI: Adam Mittner or otherwise assigned by Adam Mittner @amittner

Content DRI's will be in charge of creating their presentations based off of the template guidelines for any of the sessions. Presentations will be built in Google Slides. Once the presentation is final it will then be converted to either Keynote or PPT.

1. The Corporate Events Content Manager will provide a Google Slides template specific to the content DRI's session.
2. The Overall Content DRI will create their content using the template that was provided to them.
3. The Overall Content DRI will provide a draft of the presentation to the overall track DRI (if there is one for the project) to review and provide feedback.
4. The Overall Content DRI will make any suggested changes to the presentation and then provide the presentation to the track DRI (if there is one for the project) to review. Steps 3 & 4 will

repeat until the track DRI approves of the presentation.

If the Overall Content DRI is not the same as the presenter then at this point the main presenter will review the content - this will be the case for any E-Group presenters. The content DRI will address any feedback that the main presenter has.

5. The presentation will then be handed off to the Corporate Events Content Manager DRI to start the creative & copy edit review process having already been reviewed by the legal team, based on the materials legal review process in the handbook, if deemed necessary by the Overall Content DRI.

6. For Brand Creative review: The Corporate Events Content Manager will create a presentation request issue and work with the Brand Team or designated agency for clean up & review.

Note: Brand will not be doing major design work for these presentations. They should come for review as a final presentation that will only need to be cleaned up in terms of brand consistency and messaging.

7. For Copy Edit review: the Corporate Events Content Manager will create a content marketing issue for presentations to be reviewed from a copy editing standpoint and the content DRI will address any feedback that they have.

8. The presentation will then go to the overall content DRI/speaker and track DRI for a final review before the presentation is deemed final.

9. Once the presentation is deemed final, it will be converted to either Keynote or PPT for event execution.

Third Party Sponsored Events

Tiering of 3rd party conferences

Tier 1 -

Tier 2 -

Tier 3 -

Teams we work with internally at Tier 1 shows

Event Marketing · Project management, execute logistics, budget management, event staffing/training, lead collection/reporting, and ancillary events

Field Marketing · Field communication, meeting program support, onsite booth support, ancillary event support

Inside Sales Rep · Drive registration, booth support, lead follow-up

Customer Success (TAM, SAs attending) / Developer Relations · Booth support, attend customer meetings, presentations/speaking engagements

Product/Alliance Marketing · Messaging, content creation (blogs, sponsorship deliverables, post event emails etc), onsite booth support

Developer Advocate · Demos creation, onsite support

Social and Communications · Pre-event, on-site, post-event social content creation, PR & media

Lifecycle Marketing · Event landing pages, email blasts, database email reviews, SEO, copyedit

Recruiting - Onsite booth support

Design · Look & feel, tone, collateral (print), digital, environmental

Large & MidMarket sales teams - Attending & setting up meetings

Leading Organization Team · Executive/customer meetings, attending social events (ex: receptions, dinners), panel discussions, speaking engagements, media interviews

Staffing 3rd party sponsored event booths

The Corporate Events team collaborates with teams listed above to determine who should help to staff our 3rd party sponsored event booths. We aim to have a certain number of staff to booth size ratio that enables GitLab representatives to be diverse, knowledgeable, and welcoming for attendees. The number of staff we need is also dependent on how many days the conference schedule is. We try to utilize the following formula to staff our booths:

10x10 booth or smaller and a 2 day conference = 8-10 staff members

10x10 booth or smaller and a 3 day conference = 12-15 staff members

Staffing for a 10X10 Booth

Example of our staffing requirements for our 10x10 or smaller booth over 2 days:

1-2 - Sales/Field

6 - Demos/Technical questions

1 - Corp Events

TBD Speakers - dependent on numbers of CFP accepted

10x20 booth and a 2 day conference = 14-16 staff members

10x20 booth and a 3 day conference = 18-20 staff members

Staffing for a 10X20 Booth

Example of our staffing requirements for our 10x20 booth over 2 days:

4 - Sales/Field

10 - Demos/Technical questions

1 - Corp Events

TBD Speakers - dependent on numbers of CFP accepted

20x20 booth or larger and a 3 day conference = 32-35 staff members

20x20 booth or larger and a 4 day conference = 40 staff members

Staffing for a 20X20 Booth

Example of the staffing requirements for our 20x20 booth over 3 days:

6 - Sales/Field

12 - Demos/Technical Questions

4 - Host Counters

3 - Corp Events

8 - Lightning Talks

TBD Speakers - dependent on numbers of CFP accepted

These are estimated numbers that the Corporate Events team uses to account for budget and passes. Numbers may vary based on expected number of attendees at the show and how many days the conference is. We understand there are several business use cases where team members can travel and attend these same conferences to meet with partners, customers, and prospects. However, if the staff member is not staffing the booth or there for other purposes, the Corporate Events team is unable to cover the team member's travel and pass.

Speaking at Third Party Events

Corporate Events speaking session & CFP process

Corporate Events speaking session & CFP process references:

FY25 Sponsored Events & Epics
FY25 Dev Evangelism Event Strategy
Developer Advocate CFPs
Developer Advocate CFP Workflow

Process

Goal: ensure that GitLab's presence is widely recognized at all sponsored events.

If our sponsorship does include speaking session

If our sponsorship does include a speaking session, the sponsored events manager will create an issue with all pertinent information provided by the event. They will tag the ECM and all pertinent parties that will assist in choosing a session topic into the issue.

Once a session topic is chosen, the sponsored events manager will hand off to the ECM and content creation lead. The ECM will ensure that all deadlines are met and content is submitted per the events requirements, content is approved by legal if needed, social cards and social copy is made and provided to speakers, and calendar hold is sent to the speakers so they know where they are going on the day of their session.

If our sponsorship does not include speaking session

If our sponsorship does not include a speaking session, the ECM will ensure that our Developer Advocate team has it on their radar via the FY24 Dev Evangelism Event Strategy to submit during the event's open CFP.

If a session is chosen by an event for a CFP that was submitted, the sponsored events manager will create an issue with all pertinent information provided by the event. They will tag the ECM and all pertinent parties that will assist in creating the presentation into the issue. The sponsored events manager will hand off to the ECM and they will ensure:25 that all deadlines are met and content is submitted per the events requirements, content is approved by legal if needed, social cards and social copy is made and provided to speakers, and calendar hold is sent to the speakers so they know where they are going on the day of their session.

If the event we are sponsoring is not on the Developer Advocate team's radar to submit the CFP the ECM will start the conversation with the DE team via a comment on the strategy issue.

Lightning Talks at GitLab Booth for Third party events

Lightning Talk DRI's

Overall Content DRI: Senior Management in Product Marketing or otherwise assigned by senior management, could be vary based on event

Partner Lightning Talk DRI: Kelley Walker @kmwalker

GitLab Lightning Talk DRI: Senior Management in Product Marketing, could be vary based on

event

Corporate Events Lightning Talk Content Manager DRI: Suli King @sstuelp

Ensures that the team is on track to identify lightning talks, finalize lightning talk schedule, and that lightning talk content deadlines are being hit.

Brand Compliance DRI: Adam Mittner or otherwise assigned by Adam Mittner @amittner

Process

1. Corporate Events Content Manager to identify and communicate the number of lightning talk slots available and deadlines.
2. The Overall Content DRI will then start the process of identifying the key messaging that we would like portrayed throughout the lightning talks at the booth. They will work with the Partner Lightning Talk DRI and GitLab lightning talk DRI to communicate overall messaging and identify content that we would like to be given at our booth. Once the messaging, lightning talks, and speakers are identified and confirmed, they will fill in the lightning talk schedule in the Sponsored Event's Main Tracker. All lightning talks must be approved by the Overall Content DRI.
3. Once content is confirmed and the lightning talk schedule is finalized, content creation can begin. The Corporate Events Content Manager will create an issue for each lightning talk.
For each GitLab lightning talk the Corporate Events Content Manager will provide a GitLab branded slide template for each session. For Partner lightning talks, the partner can create their lightning talk on their own company's branded template.
Issue template for GitLab Lightning Talks
Issue template for Partner Lightning Talks
4. Once GitLab content is created, it will then go through the review process which will entail: Overall Content DRI Review and Brand Compliance DRI Review. Reviewers will leave feedback as comments in the slide presentation to be addressed.
5. Once Partner content is created, it will then go through the review process which will entail: Overall Content DRI Review. Reviewers will leave feedback as comments in the slide presentation to be addressed.
6. Once the content has gone through the review process and all reviewer comments have been addressed the content will then be deemed final.

GitLab DevSecOps World Tour

DevSecOps World Tour - Planning Epic coming soon

GitLab DevSecOps World Tour, GitLab's user conference, is an event that connects you to the ideas, technologies, and people that are driving DevSecOps transformation and is for the technology champions responsible for building, operating and securing applications.

Event Execution

For event execution instructions, please see the Marketing Events page for detailed instruction and the criteria used to determine what type of events are supported.

For both GitLab-owned and external events, speakers and content DRIs should build in steps for legal approvals from necessary parties on public-facing presentations before materials are due.

Labels used by the Corporate Events Team

Label	Use
Corporate Event	For all General Corporate Events related issues
Corporate Marketing	For all General Corporate Marketing issue tracking
Events	For all GitLab events
Sponsored Corporate Events	For all Sponsored in-person trade shows, events, auxiliary events, etc.
Virtual Events	For all Virtual Owned Events
Virtual Conference	For all Virtual Sponsored Events
Hybrid Conference	For all Sponsored events with an in-person and virtual component

DevSecOps World Tour
For all DevSecOps World Tour events

Issue Templates used by the Corporate Events Team

Event Execution Issue Templates
Event DRI Template
Event Travel Staffing Template
EventAncillaryTemplate
Promotional Game Rules Template
Sponsored Corporate Event Template

Internal Partner Issue Templates used by the Corporate Events Team

Internal Partner Issue Templates

FM Event SDR Support Issue Template
Social Media Event Promotion Issue Template
PR Media Podcast Involvement Issue Template
Brand Asset Design Requests Issue Template
Upload Clean Lead List Post Event Issue Template
Post Event Video Upload Issue Template
Pre & Post event outbound email Issue Template

Best Practices on site at a GitLab event

Employee Booth Guidelines
Scanning Best Practices

Accessibility at GitLab Hosted Events

In advance of the event, we promise that we will take into account the following

Accessibility will not be an afterthought.

Events will be inclusive and accessible.

Venues will meet International Accessibility Standards guidelines.

There will be seating available and accessible seating made available upon request

There will be gender neutral pronouns in event communication.

General dress guidance will not include male/female binary descriptors, and attendees can decide for themselves what works best for them.

Feedback will be collected during and after the event to gauge accessibility and comfort levels.

Designated confidential resources will be available for team members.

Name badges will have write-in areas, printed or stickers for preferred pronouns.

Large group meals will have ingredients and allergens listed. If you have communicated your needs with the event staff and the kitchen cannot provide a suitable meal for you, there will be a designated amount you can expense per meal on site.

The Events team will commit to the idea that no detail is too small

For all GitLab hosted events of 300+ we hire security that is also certified in first aid.

Communicating Accessibility

Gathering attendee needs during registration.

Dietary restrictions: If you have any questions, please follow up with the individual privately. Determine the specific restrictions and provide information on how ingredients will be provided. Offer solutions in case there is an issue onsite so that the attendee is prepared.

Additional needs: Include an open text area in which attendees can list specific needs to help ensure full guest participation. Example requests include:

- Interpreting services

- Assistive listening devices

- Accessible parking

- Accessible hotel rooms

- Captioning

- Reserved front row seat

- Wheelchair access to working tables throughout the room

- Lactation room

- Seating for in-person events

The team will make all good faith efforts to carry out requests, or will open lines of discussion for options when not available.

Preferred pronouns: Aim to avoid a closed field for gender and instead provide a blank write-in field or inclusive dropdown options so attendees can select/type their preference pending on the badging system. This information will be displayed on name badges, or available to add with stickers etc. Email and landing page communication

Put accessibility information in the event page footer or have a page dedicated to accessibility.

Send out email on accessibility specifics and resources in advance of the event. Examples of what to communicate in that email:

- Use of flash photography

- Any sort of strobe lights or flashing images that may cause seizures

- Distinctly amplified sounds/music

- The use of fog machines/any other chemicals or smells that may make your space inaccessible

to individuals with Multiple Chemical Sensitivity (MCS) or Idiopathic Environmental Intolerances (IEI)

Whether interpreting services will be provided for various speakers, panels, talks, etc.

Whether assistive listening devices will be provided.

All optional parts of your event, including off-site social activities, that may not be fully accessible.

Information about meals and dietary restrictions.

Accessible transportation options

First Aid/Medical Assistance options

Info on how to get in touch with questions or concerns.

For speakers

Speak clearly (ideally facing forward without covering your mouth)

Avoid acronyms and colloquialisms as much as possible

When addressing someone specifically, ask for his/her/their name and confirm pronouns

Specify when you're finished speaking

For interpreters, always look at and address the participating attendee

Repeat questions posted by the audience before responding, especially if there is not a roving microphone available.

Virtual Events at GitLab

At GitLab, the Corporate Events team owns events that meet specific criteria ([link](#)), including those events that have a global hybrid or virtual element. By design, virtual events at GitLab are not a simple video call nor are they a static playlist. GitLab virtual events aim to retain the same brand personality, engagement, inclusivity, and fun as our in-person events.

Lead time

A GitLab virtual event requires 16+ weeks of lead time in order to accommodate the successful planning, scripting, set-up, recording, editing, and executing of a program.

What does a virtual GitLab event entail?

Virtual events require considerable lead time and effort to plan, especially if there are any planned live elements.

Branding: Requesting event-specific branding, including event logo, slide deck template, brand kit, and brand colors

Platform: Determining a virtual event platform to allow for maximum engagement, clarify, and streaming stability

Content: Collaborating with event content owners to develop messaging, content arc, and other thematic elements

Community: Working with event content owners to invite community speakers and source subject matter experts

Communications: Building content for event landing pages, registration, speaker communications, cross-functional promotion, and internal team training

Budget: Fleshing out budget and sponsorship

Support: GitLab speaker support and content development, as outlined in the Commit Speaker

page

Production: Selecting production partners to provide support on speaker recording, editing, live-streaming, and entertainment

Approval : Ensuring all speakers and content undergo rigorous review and necessary approvals, as dictated by both GitLab Legal and speaker or partner requirements

Follow-up: Collaborating with Social Media, Digital Production, Marketing Ops, Content, Sales Development, Customer Reference, Community, Product Marketing, and Legal to allow for adequate post-event planning

Why Does GitLab Pre-Record Content?

Benefits of pre-recording

Allows for multiple takes and editing/ splicing any errors

Allows for a polished delivery, increased professionalism, and addition of production elements

Encourages real-time Q&A via session chat so attendees can ask questions as they come up rather than saving all questions for the end

Enables speakers to enjoy the day-of content rather than focusing solely on their presentation(s)

Reduces the risk of wifi/ server/ bandwidth-related issues, providing stability and security

Reduces stress for speakers; less focus on timing, connectivity, Q&A, etc.

How pre-recording for a virtual event increases engagement

Speakers can call-out or otherwise acknowledge individuals in the session chat, where seeing faces might be challenging in-person

Speakers can answer questions as they come in, rather than waiting until the end when attendees may have forgotten or left

Link to any resources as needed

If there are no questions, feel free to post an FAQ (and answer) or 2

Gamefy it! Any cool trivia or info that you didn't have time to cover in your talk? Add nuggets in the chat throughout the session

"I'm going to sprinkle in the chat 4 little-known facts about Kubernetes · get ready!"

Execution

In order to create a premium virtual event experience, the Corporate Events team executes virtual events in order to maximize global audience participation and engagement. The considerations in place include:

Either timezone specific programming, or multiple segments to cover global timezones

Events team online before, throughout, and after the event to ensure coverage and support

A minimum of 2+ weeks for editing and captioning of content: Because GitLab's content is technical and its community is so passionate, Events is committed to ensuring precise captioning so that all attendees can contribute

Live-stream stability and fall-back planning: As a fully virtual and remote-first organization, we believe in the power of asynchronous work

Accessibility

The Corporate Events team believes that everyone can contribute to virtual events, and so prepares for content to be varied, accessible, and time appropriately to enable as much mental and physical engagement as possible. Plans include:

- Generating human-reviewed captions for all sessions
- Building in breaks that are fun and energizing
- Making session recordings available post-event for on-demand consumption
- Ensuring a variety of sessions and content to encourage contribution from all organizations and business functions

Best Virtual Event Speaker Practices

Having run several global-focused virtual events, the GitLab team has some best practices and recommendations to share with prospective speakers.

Corporate Events' Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging Initiatives

As part of the event planning and execution process at GitLab, the event lead will ensure that diversity, inclusion, and belonging initiatives are taken into consideration throughout the entire event process.

Content Creation

The planning committee will ensure that there is an inclusive environment when selecting CFP/keynote/speakers which aligns with GitLab's event requirements for speaking. This includes researching and sourcing for speakers from underrepresented groups and with various backgrounds including:

- Ability, disability, and ableism
- Faith and/or religious identity
- Gender identity
- Racial identity
- Global citizenship
- Intergenerational differences
- Sexual respect
- LGBTQIA+ identity

Venue/Vendor/Supplier Selection

When working with a vendor or supplier, the team will ensure that the selected venue/vendor/supplier is supportive of GitLab's DIB values. These may include, but are not limited to the following:

- LGBTQIA+, racial, faith/religious, and gender friendly
- Are able to accommodate accessibility needs or are able to make special arrangements if needed
- Work with diverse and locally owned businesses when possible
- Avoid any religious and cultural days of observance
- Partner with venues that have all-gendered restrooms or are willing to designate specific restrooms as gender neutral, as well as setting up any additional designated rooms as needed (i.e. lactation room, prayer room, etc.)

GitLab Hosted Events Best Practices

During registration, when applicable, include questions about dietary needs and accessibility needs.

Ensure there is reserved seating available who may need/request for it (i.e. pregnant attendees, attendees with disabilities, older attendees, etc.).

Ensure that signage, tables, spacing, and other materials are easily accessible and readable for all attendees.

Provide pronoun stickers or pins for attendees to include on their badges.

Use inclusive language and naming conventions in all messaging and content.

Provide a safe environment for all attendees with additional resources available.

Ensure enough time is given for any team member who may need to apply for a visa when applicable.

The ability for team members or attendees to do normal activities safely and without restrictions at the event (i.e. gender neutral bathrooms, lactation room, prayer room, etc).

Provide a physically safe environment for as many people to participate in activities/excursions (i.e. accessibility).

Environmental Sustainability Initiatives

At GitLab, the Corporate Events team wants to continue to play our part and operate with integrity when we are making decisions. The team is consciously making decisions that help align with the company's social and environmental efforts.

The Corporate Events team works with our swag vendor that sources swag with a goal of 95% of swag is sustainable or eco-friendly or work with companies that have sustainable initiatives. Some categories that the Corporate Events team considers when selecting suppliers are:

Union Made Products

Give-Back Programs

Eco Products

Supplier Diversity

Women Owned

Black Owned

Asian-Am Owned

Hispanic/Latinx-Am Owner

Native American Owned

Native Hawaiian/PI Owned

Owner with Disability

Veteran Owned

LGBTQIA+ Owned

Small Business Enterprise

Small Disadvantaged Business

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/_index.md

Digital Strategy

The Digital Strategy team generates new prospects through paid channels by building & managing digital marketing campaigns, testing incremental changes for conversion rate improvement, and tracking campaign performance.

Go to our Digital Strategy Management page for all Digital Marketing strategy, process, request intake, and channel information.

Go to the agency page to learn more about the team's partnership, media planning, and communication with our ad agency, PMG.

Team

- Sara Valko - Digital Marketing Manager
- Joon Shin - Sr. Digital Marketing Manager
- Social Marketing

[Click here](#) to learn about the Digital Marketing Programs role.

Digital Strategy Responsibilities

Digital Strategy is responsible for planning, launching, and optimizing paid ad campaigns, with a focus on top of funnel demand generation to support regional and segment pipelines, and iterating on programs to progress qualified inquiries to MQL and SAO.

Reporting

Information about reporting done by the Digital Marketing Programs team and across the Marketing functional group can be found in the Reporting section of the Digital Marketing Management page.

Digital Marketing Tools

We use a variety of tools to support other teams within the company. Details about the tech stack, who has access and the system admins are found on the Tech Stack Applications page of the Business Operations handbook section.

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/agency.md

PMG {agency}

Who is PMG?

The GitLab Digital Strategy team works directly with our digital agency PMG to execute all paid digital campaigns. PMG fees are a percentage of the paid digital advertising spend, so total budgets will include the effective spend + PMG fee. For GitLab digital initiatives, PMG contributions & activities include:

- Working closely with GitLab on quarterly and monthly media planning for primarily top and

middle funnel paid digital strategy that aligns with GitLab pipeline goals.

- Building and executing campaign launches once all materials and direction are received from the GitLab side.
- Strategically & competitively bidding and negotiating for efficient ad units and sponsorship programs.
- Continuously optimizing campaigns and programs for more efficient rates and higher lead quality.
- Aggregating all campaigns into Alli (PMG's marketing intelligence platform), featuring multiple filters to view performance from audience, asset, segment, team, and regional angles.
- Reviewing overall metrics over time to uncover trends & opportunities, as well as pitching new campaign & placement ideas to uplevel coverage and performance.
- Setting up all digital spend with channels and vendors to bill directly through PMG, and syncing with GitLab Finance to handle invoicing monthly.

The GitLab PMG Team {team}

- Craig Calloway - Client Strategy (core)
- Maddie Mingus - Client Strategy, Publishers, Search (core)
- Kayla Peaden - Client Strategy (core)
- Natalia Prescod - Social (core - interim)
- Eman Bader - Program (core - not yet hired)
- Soren Dahl - Social (core - interim)
- Nicole Slaski - Search (Interim)
- Corinne Smallwood - Analytics Coordinator - Data Analyst, Alli Dashboard
- Casandra Jones - Senior Director, Client Strategy

Communication {communication}

GitLab & PMG communicate mainly through the GitLab Digital Advertising project. Both teams also share a Slack workspace to connect on quick questions & general updates.

GitLab Project {project}

Digital Advertising Project - The Digital Marketing team works directly with PMG within the GitLab Digital Advertising project, which is strictly for Digital Marketing & PMG communication only. In special cases, members of GitLab's Marketing Campaigns or Marketing Operations teams will communicate within this project for technical troubleshooting.

GitLab Issues {issues}

PMG Issues within the Digital Advertising project cover campaign requests, changes, budgeting, planning, optimizations, and logging of any technical issues.

It's important for team members (both PMG and GitLab) update assignees, milestones, and labels to indicate responsibility for next steps in the handoff (see labels and milestones below)

GitLab Labels {labels}

Label	Category	Definition

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todo:pmg	Todo	Label to notate the next step is in the hands of PMG Digital
todo:gitlab	Todo	Label to notate the next step is in the hands of GitLab
DG-PMG-priority::TBD	Priority	Priority of the issue is TBD
DG-PMG-priority::Low	Priority	Priority of the issue is Low
DG-PMG-priority::Medium	Priority	Priority of the issue is Medium
DG-PMG-priority::High	Priority	Priority of the issue is High
pmg-abmktg	Team	Label for all issue related to the campaigns for Account Based Marketing department
pmg-demandgen	Team	Label for all issue related to the demand generation team
pmg-fieldmktg	Team	Label for all issue related to the field marketing campaigns
dg-pmg-info	Informational	Label for issues that is only informational. No action items
dg-pmg: Admin	Informational	Label for issues that are administrative (process, budgeting, etc.)
dg-pmg: Reporting	Todo	Label for issues that execution is complete but reporting is needed
pmg-meeting	Informational	For issues that are recaps from meetings
paid social	Channel	For campaigns that include paid social
paid search	Channel	For campaigns that include paid search
display advertising	Channel	For campaigns that include paid display
sponsorships	Channel	For campaigns that include paid sponsorships

GitLab Milestones {milestones}

PMG Milestones contain issues based on one week iterations, from Mondays to the following Sunday. Issue owners will add to the current week's milestone (DG-PMG: [Monday date] - [following Sunday date]) or the next week's milestone (DG-PMG: [next Monday date] - [following Sunday date]) depending on priority and if the issue requires immediate action. The DG-PMG: Backlog milestone contains issues that are either not ready to be actioned on or currently blocked, as well as issues that are technically completed but still open for monitoring. The DG-PMG: Backlog Follow Up milestone contains issues that have been moved out of general backlog and are ready for follow up analysis.

PMG Triage Board is assembled to track issues within the current & next week milestones. Layering on the todo:pmg and todo:gitlab labels will display which issues are currently being

handled by which team. Each week, the Digital Marketing team and PMG meet to review the current status for each issue & initiative within these milestones.

Email & Slack

While GitLab & PMG communicate mainly through the GitLab Digital Advertising project, both teams also share a Slack workspace to connect on quick questions & general updates.

Digital Marketing Meetings {meetings}

Weekly Triage {triage}

PMG and GitLab meet weekly to review issues from the milestone triage board in the Digital Advertising project to determine the current status, blockers and immediate action items needed to advance issues further. Issues are reviewed based on todo labels and moved into the appropriate milestone based on priority and timing of next steps.

Weekly GitLab+PMG Meetings {weekly-meetings}

The Digital Marketing and (optional) Marketing Campaigns team members meet with PMG weekly to cover one of the following sessions on a rotating basis:

- Monthly Review: Typically the second week of each month, reviewing the previous month's full paid digital campaign performance in alignment with MQL & SAO goals, plus discussing key learnings and areas of opportunity.
- Deep Dive: Diving into a specific channel, region, segment, campaign, etc to discuss coverage, metrics and actionable insights.
- Flex/Working Sessions: Using our weekly meeting to work through key initiatives or upcoming media planning.
- Brainstorming: Leveraging our learnings & market trends toward improved creative, assets, messaging, audiences, or channel performance.

QBRs {qbrs}

Digital Demand Gen QBRs are typically held during the 3rd week of February, May, August, and November. PMG presents full performance & analysis of the previous quarter's digital campaigns, broken down by segment, channel, region, GTM, content, audiences targeting, etc. QBRs usually produce a higher volume of follow-up action item issues based on key learnings.

Revenue Marketing QBRs are scheduled separately from the main Digital Demand Gen QBRs. These reviews focus on campaign performance from the previous quarter for Corporate, Field, and Account Based Marketing teams.

Digital Advertising Issue & Board Management {issue-board-management}

GitLab and PMG triage issues and plan the completion of work in relevant milestones on Tuesday of each week. In order for this process to work effectively, each week ALL team members should review the issue board and ensure the issue are progressing towards completion within the designated milestone. Best practices include the following:

- Review issues and make comments of the current status, @ mentioning relevant stakeholders that should be included
- Update assignee and to-do label to the correct DRI if that has changed
- If the milestone has expired and the work is NOT completed, move the issue to a following milestone unless there is a problem that needs discussed during weekly triage. Note: if the issue has been moved multiple times without progress, bring the issue to the triage meeting to help move it forward
- Friday or Monday are recommended days to review milestone boards. This allows you to close out one week and prepare your activities for the coming week

Channel & Vendor Relations {channels-vendors}

Publishers {publishers}

PMG initiates & manages Publisher/Sponsorship contracts using the following process:

- Pre-RFP
 - GitLab and PMG collaborate to confirm the available quarterly budget, targeting guidelines, and GitLab's content priorities for publisher programs.
- RFP Process
 - PMG begins the RFP process by contacting multiple vendors that may be a potential fit. (PMG handles all email and phone communication with vendors). Ideally, for any particular initiative
 - it is best to stick to a maximum of 3 potential partners to look into.
 - Based on a vendor's program offerings and targeting capabilities, PMG will evaluate and recommend potential vendors to GitLab.
 - Once GitLab has decided on a recommended vendor(s), PMG will handle contracting the program-vendors bill PMG directly.
- Campaign Process
 - Once the contract is signed by PMG and the vendor, program deliverables are posted to a new issue by PMG.
 - GitLab will post completed deliverables to the issue and PMG will pass the information along to the vendor.
 - If the program generates leads, leads will be sent directly from the vendor to GitLab for PII/GDPR reasons. GitLab must ensure that GDPR language is in place when the user downloads GitLab content from the vendor's site.
 - The designated sender at GitLab will then open a publisher engagement epic to upload lead lists and enable program tracking.

Channel Rep Syncs {channel-reps}

PMG meets with channel reps (LinkedIn, Google, Brighttalk, etc) on either a monthly or as needed basis. These syncs may cover specialized reports/technical deep dives, UI updates and current product roadmaps, and channel/platform news.

Campaign Strategy & Planning {strategy-planning}

Demand Generation Campaigns {campaigns}

Budget Allocation

Before the beginning of each fiscal year, GitLab and PMG meet to review the Digital Marketing

budget and plan its quarterly allocation. This allocation will be primarily determined by KPI goals, sales coverage, and seasonality.

- Please refer to this Mural for GitLab's FY23 Paid Digital Campaign structure.

Before each upcoming quarter, the teams will meet for media planning sessions to determine the coverage mix for our paid digital programs. Given the quarter's KPI goals as a whole & per segment/region, the media planning's key topics include the degree of coverage for the following (tiers listed in order of visualization):

- Audience Targeting
 - Segments: Enterprise, Mid-Market, and SMB
 - General Prospecting: for coverage outside of segment-targeting platforms
 - Retargeting: account lists or pixel audiences
 - Publisher Programs: each publisher has its own unique audience filters
- Region
 - AMER, EMEA, APAC, PubSec
- Platform Targeting
 - Prospecting, Retargeting, or Account Targeting
- Platforms
 - LinkedIn, Facebook, Twitter, Google Search, Google Display
- Use Cases
 - DevOps Platform, CI/CD, GitOps, DevSecOps, VC&C, Ecomm, etc
- Content
 - eBooks, Whitepapers, Demos, Fireside Chats, etc.

The final asset mix for each budget line item will be recorded in the Paid Demand Generation Asset Tracker, with each month's assets separated by tab.

Intake Process

1. GitLab submits a campaign request issue for PMG containing all required campaign materials, as well as a detailed description explaining the purpose and goal for this new initiative or asset(s).
2. PMG reviews the request, providing suggestions & direction where necessary based on (1) how the new campaign will fit into the current media plan & budget, (2) account best practices, and (3) region/segment/use case/platform historical success.
PMG forecasts an optimal campaign budget based on target audience size and average costs & conversion rates (forecasts will vary by platform).
3. PMG generates ad copy builds & mockups.
4. GitLab approves campaign plan & final materials.
5. PMG launches (or schedules a later launch) and records the new asset(s) in the Paid Demand Generation Asset Tracker.

Optimization

Top metrics include CPI (cost per inquiry) and INQ, MQL & SAO conversion rates. After exiting the learning phase, PMG will monitor the new campaign/asset for any unusual or inefficient performance. During monthly performance recaps, PMG will highlight new campaign/asset performance in relation to the baseline top metrics of the regional, segment & platform

historical performance and provide optimization recommendations if necessary.

Demand Gen Ancillary Campaigns {ancillary-campaigns}

The GitLab Digital Marketing team receives additional funding at various times throughout the fiscal year to support gaps in the pipeline or test & expand on new initiatives. Both teams follow the same intake process outlined above, but since these funds are limited to the month or quarter, additional strategy is required in order to hit the funding's targets within a short amount of time.

PMG provides pulse checks & tracking toward KPIs more frequently for ancillary campaigns than regular campaigns since their duration is limited to the month or quarter. Once the ancillary campaign has completed, PMG will provide a campaign summary and key insights for future iterations.

Field, ABM and Corporate Campaigns {external-campaigns}

Intake Process

1. All departments outside of Digital/Demand Generation must first go through the Coupa Purchase Order process in order to start the intake process with PMG.
 - Please see PMG's Statement of Work template and sample SOWs [here](#).
2. GitLab submits a campaign request issue for PMG containing all required campaign materials, as well as a detailed description explaining the purpose and goal for this event or new initiative.
3. PMG reviews the request and forecasts an optimal campaign budget based on target audience size and average costs & conversion rates.
4. PMG generates ad copy builds & mockups.
5. GitLab approves campaign plan & final materials.
6. PMG launches (or schedules a later launch) and records the new campaign in the Field, ABM, and Corporate Marketing campaign log for each quarter (9 campaign launch limit).

Optimization

KPIs are based on campaign goals, so events will focus on cost per registrations while other campaigns could focus on inquiries & engagement. Similar to regular Demand Gen campaigns, PMG will monitor the new campaign for any unusual or inefficient performance and provide optimization suggestions if necessary. Once the campaign has completed, PMG will provide a campaign summary and key insights for future iterations.

Reporting & Analytics {reporting}

UTM Structure {utms}

The UTM structure is at the core of all of PMG's reporting. The UTM parameters that the team has chosen are used for all paid digital activations and are tracked using Alli and displayed in the GitLab-PMG Datastudio dashboard. PMG uses the following parameters to report on digital performance:

- utmmedium

- utmsource
- utmcampaign
- utmcontent

PMG uses the following rules when building UTM and platform names:

- Use the GitLab Platform Campaign Name & UTM Parameter Builder to start any URL or platform campaign name, never from scratch.
- All letters should be lowercase only.
- For campaign/content utm, there should be no blank values. Always select from the dropdown. x is most often used as a placeholder when there is not a correct value to choose from.
- Hyphens - and Underscores can be used accordingly:
 - Underscores are used as our delimiter - that is, they separate one dimension from another.
 - Hyphens are used to combine multiple elements together of the same category. Example being geo: amer-california; or emea-turkey
 - Another example could be in targeting; we are doing ABM, but also retargeting: abm-rtg
- Whenever adding a country or state to the geo, always spell the full name, never abbreviate.
- The last thing in any url string should be an underscore, to prevent any additional elements from being added to links like GCLID often does.
- Always use the Paid Social Campaign Name tab in the GitLab Platform Campaign Name & UTM Parameter Builder to build social campaign names. The Campaign Name is the joining point we use to integrate with Google Analytics data to report on conversions.
 - This is different than in Google CPC and Display, where we use Final URL to join/stack with Analytics data.

Creating the utmcontent name follows a similar process:

- Content name is either provided by GitLab or taken from the URL of the content/web page
- Content name is created using the following identifiers:
 - Content name
 - Team
 - Budget
 - Language
- Example: contentteambudgetlanguage

Alli {agency-reporting}

Alli is PMG's marketing intelligence platform created to provide a single view of all your data to then accelerate your business by normalizing your marketing data, automating actions, and activating insights based on your custom goals and needs.

Alli is used to power the GitLab-PMG Datastudio dashboard that connects platform data with Google360 and Sis